

future world demands, or to hedge against present investments.

5. Insured Savings Account—available through banks, credit unions, and other financial institutions; insured by a government agency (FDIC) up to \$100,000 per account; considered safe and convenient; easy to open.
6. Mutual Funds—diversified investment alternative; for individual investors to pool dollars that are professionally managed, to meet various investment objectives.
7. Stocks—investment that represents a share of ownership in a company; value of the stock may increase or decrease, based on the success, or perceived success, of the corporation.
8. Treasury Issues—bills, notes, or bonds, in denominations of \$1,000 to \$1 million; mature from thirty days to more than five years after their issue by the Treasury Department.
9. U.S. Savings Bonds—available through many financial institutions and payroll deduction plans; provide an opportunity to invest in the U.S. government by buying a bond with a set maturity date at a price below face value.

The worst thing Martha can do is nothing. She is frozen by the unpredictability of the stock market. The fact remains that none of us have a crystal ball. We can't guess which funds will perform well and which will not. The only sure forecast is that not investing will guarantee that you miss out on huge potential gains.

Chasing the Hot Dot

Many people believe that making money in the stock market is all about “buying low and selling high” within a very short

